



Mohammad Jamil Ahmed ▾

[Details](#)[My Team](#)[Team building instructions](#)[Complete the hackathon](#)

IBM TechXchange 2026 Pre-conference Dev Day Hackathon

Team-building opens

August 27, 2026, 4:00 PM ET

Registration closes

August 28, 2026, 9:00 AM ET

Hackathon start

August 28, 2026, 10:00 AM ET

Submissions close

August 30, 2026, 10:00 AM ET

IBM TechXchange 2026 Pre-conference Dev Day Hackathon

[Get ready](#) | [During the hackathon](#) | [Judging](#) | [Prizes](#)

Welcome and thank you for joining.

Build with purpose using IBM Bob 2.0

Create a solution that improves a specific developer workflow, such as onboarding, debugging, code review, testing, application maintenance, or release and deployment processes. Start by clearly defining a problem where time, effort, or errors are too high today. Then, using IBM Bob 2.0, build a working prototype on a real or sample project that demonstrates a full solution to improve the specified workflow. Leverage features like Agent mode, parallel tasks, subagents, and document understanding to manage and improve multiple steps, not just assist with coding. Clearly demonstrate impact by showing how your solution increases productivity, reduces manual effort, errors, and rework, or significantly shortens the time required to complete tasks.

Get ready ahead of the hackathon

Before the hackathon starts, prepare by completing these steps:

- Teams can have 1-5 participants. Review the [Team building instructions page](#) to create or join a team any time.
- We know you're excited to start your hackathon project, but we ask that you **do not set anything up or start working on your project in IBM Bob ahead of time**. It's best to wait for official hackathon set-up instructions. For now, simply make sure your desktop or laptop device will be able to upload and download files to participate in the hackathon.

- Let your network know you're participating! [Download the tile](#) (Right-click on the image to save it) and share on your social media with the hashtag #watsonxHackathon.

During the hackathon

When the hackathon is open, look for the "Complete the hackathon" page on this site for detailed, step-by-step instructions.

Step 1: As the hackathon starts you will find instructions on the ["Complete the hackathon"](#) page to request your team's IBM Bob and IBM Cloud accounts for use during the hackathon.

Step 2: From that same page, download the "hackathon guide". This guide will include any necessary steps to set up your accounts and get you familiar with Bob, watsonx, and what they can do.

Step 3: Before the hackathon deadline, follow the submission instructions on the "Complete the hackathon" page carefully to submit your project for a chance to win prizes.

Judging

Each submission will be scored based on the following criteria with a maximum score of 20 points, and the final score being the average of the judges' scores.

- **Completeness and feasibility** (5 points): How feasible is the solution? How fully has the idea been thought-out and planned? How complete is the proof-of-concept submitted? How clear is the application of IBM technology?
- **Creativity and innovation** (5 points): How unique and original was the approach in applying AI technology to address the stated issue? Is the solution differentiated in the market?
- **Design and usability** (5 points): How good is the design, user experience, and ease-of-use of the solution? How quickly and easily could it be put to use

in real-world scenarios and adopted by target users?

- **Effectiveness and efficiency** (5 points): Does the solution address a high priority and relevant issue within the hackathon theme? Does it achieve its goal effectively and efficiently? Can it achieve a measurable impact in the field? Does it have potential to scale to more users or use cases?

Prizes

Top teams can win:

- First place team:
 - \$2,000 USD
 - 1 ticket per team member, including travel and lodging*, to IBM TechXchange 2026 conference, October 26-29, 2026, Atlanta, Georgia (Tickets are subject to legal pre-approval and are non-transferable)
- Second place team: \$1,000 USD
- Third place team: \$500 USD
- The 50 top scoring qualified submissions will receive 1 ticket per team member to IBM TechXchange 2026 conference, October 26-29, 2026, Atlanta, Georgia (Tickets are subject to legal pre-approval, are non-transferable, and travel/lodging not included)

** Trip is subject to legal pre-approval and is non-transferable. If traveling from outside the United States, it is your personal responsibility to understand any U.S. entry requirements and obtain any visas or entrance documents required for your host country and any other country you plan to visit. If you are required to obtain a visa prior to departure, please factor in processing times, as they vary based on your country of residence. Failure to obtain any necessary visas in a timely manner, prior to departure, will result in your inability to enter the U.S. in time to participate in the IBM TechXchange 2026 conference. Upon request, IBM can provide a visa invitation letter for registered attendees. The cost of obtaining such a visa will not be covered by IBM and IBM shall not be liable for the consequences to any contestant resulting from his or her failure to obtain such documents or visas.*

Review the [Official Rules](#).

